

Page 1: Student Scaffold

Story Problems Vocabulary & Supports

Key Vocabulary

Story problem / Problema: Math written as a story with numbers and actions

Add to / Agregar: Put more with what you have (joining two groups)

Take from / Quitar: Remove or take away some (separating a group)

How many / Cuántos: Asking for the total amount

Altogether / En total: All together as one group

Left / Quedan: What remains after taking away

Show / Mostrar: Represent using objects, drawings, or actions

Represent / Representar: Show your thinking in different ways

Sentence Frames for Explaining

For Add To problems:

"First, I had _____. Then I added _____. Now I have _____."

"I showed _____ and _____ joining together."

For Take From problems:

"I started with _____. I took away _____. Now I have _____ left."

"I showed _____ and removed _____."

For Putting Together problems:

"_____ and _____ altogether is _____."

"I have ___ in one group and ___ in the other group. Altogether, I have ___."

Ways to Show Your Thinking

- ✓ **Act it out:** Use your body or ask friends to help show the story
- ✓ **Draw pictures:** Draw circles, lines, or simple shapes
- ✓ **Use objects:** Use counters, cubes, or things you have
- ✓ **Write or say:** Tell or write the numbers

Pick ONE way that makes sense to you!

Partner Talk Prompt

When working with a partner:

"What did you notice first in the story?"

"How did you show the story?"

"What numbers did you use?"

Page 2: Teacher MLR Notes

MLR8 Discussion Supports (Recommended)

Why: Grade 1 Spanish learners need processing time and sentence support to narrate their representations. MLR8 provides structured turns and frames.

During Activity 1 (Act Out Stories):

Before acting: "What happens first in the story? What happens next?"

After acting: Display frames: "First, we _____. Then we _____. Last, we _____."

Invite 1-2 students to use frames to narrate what the actors did.

During Activity 2 (Represent Stories):

Launch Language (Read Aloud + Simplified):

"We read a story. The story tells us something that happens. We show what happens in the story. We can draw. We can use objects. We can act. Show the story your way."

Partner Talk Prompt (Before Independent Work):

"Turn to your partner. Tell your partner what happens in the story. Use these words: First... Then... Now..."

Wait 20-30 seconds for thinking. Then say: "Tell your partner now."

Anticipated Language Barriers

- **Understanding "take away":** Spanish learners may confuse "take from" with physical taking. Gesture: Show a group, remove some with your hand, point to what's left.
- **Distinguishing "add to" vs "put together":** Both mean joining, but context differs. "Add to" = action over time; "Put together" = two separate groups. Use motion for "add" and stillness for "put together."

- **Following two-step stories:** Break into one action at a time: "What happens first?" (STOP)
"What happens next?" (STOP)
- **Production burden:** Drawing/writing alone is risky. Provide peer discussion + visual representation first, then reduce production demand.

Look-Fors During Discussion (Activity 2 Synthesis)

- ✓ Student uses object/gesture/drawing + language to explain the story
- ✓ Student correctly sequences the action (what happened first, then, last)
- ✓ Student identifies the starting amount and the amount that changed
- ✓ Student uses sentence frames or approximations ("I put 5... then add 2 more...")
- ✓ Student connects their representation to the numbers in the story

Note: Expect translations and code-switching. Revoice in English + validate the math thinking.

Revoicing & Validation Moves

When student says (in Spanish or approximation): "Tengo cinco y dos más"

You revoice: "Yes! You have 5, and you added 2 more. So you have 7 altogether."

When student draws but doesn't explain:

"Show me with your finger. Here are the 5 counters (point). Here are the 2 you added (point). How many is that?"

When student acts out correctly but struggles with words:

"I watched you take away 3. Nice! You had 10, took away 3, and now you have 7 left."

Differentiation Notes for Your 8 Spanish Learners

Pre-lesson (5 min, small group): Act out 1 simple "add to" story with the group before whole-class lesson. Narrate: "First we have 2. Then we get 1 more. Now we have 3."

During Activity 1: Invite Spanish learners to be the actors first (lower language demand, high math engagement). Peers narrate afterward.

During Activity 2: Pair each Spanish learner with a peer who can talk. Provide sentence frame cards on the table. Check in: "Tell me what happens in the story first."

During Synthesis: Call on Spanish learners who used strong representations (drawings or objects). Provide the frame: "You showed _____. Tell me more."